

Ever Bothered About Your Mobile's Operating System?

When buying a mobile phone, we consider the cosmetic factors, but the chief criteria for the selection of a mobile phone should actually be the operating system, which heavily impacts the phone's performance



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Slim, sleek, trendy! That's what we usually look for while shopping for our most-favoured gadgets—smartphones. The looks, size, shape, weight and, of course, the price of mobile phones get the most weightage when we are making our buying decisions. But what about the operating systems (OS) that are inside them? We forget that the latest features we search for in a mobile phone depend on the OS it runs on. The OS of a mobile phone heavily impacts its performance. The better the OS, the smoother the user experience. How ex-

actly does one know which is a better OS? Let us review the different kinds of OS offered by various vendors and their features.

No matter how mobile savvy a user is, he generally knows about Windows and Symbian OS only. Besides these, the other OS available in the market currently include Apple iPhone and BlackBerry. Here, we will look into the OS and their features that can become the basis of your buying decision.

Symbian

For a long period of time, smartphone users had a limited choice

of OS, with Symbian and Windows enjoying the edge, and Nokia banking mostly on Symbian. Symbian OS, developed by the Symbian Foundation, was originally distributed under a proprietary licence but, with time, it is drifting towards open source and Eclipse public licence. The latest stable version available for Symbian OS is v 9.4.

The default user interface (UI) for Symbian OS is S60 platform, UIQ, MOAP. User interface is a software platform that runs on top of the Symbian OS. It basically contains the user application. So, in Symbian, we have S60 as one of the UIs. The S60 is currently owned by Nokia, who licenses it to other manufacturers like LG Electronics and Samsung.

Symbian users can enjoy a rich multimedia experience with advanced camera features similar to standalone digital cameras with 35 new features. These include image orientation following tilt sensor, preset image enhancements, digital/optical zoom, auto-focus spots, panorama stitch and image distortion correction, auto-focus and red-eye reduction.

With improved seamless connectivity to home computers and the facilitation of easy transfer of music, videos and images, one smartphone can replace several devices. Besides, with the support for multi-standard digital TV, the Symbian smartphone brings true convergence to consumers worldwide.